

SHYAM

श्याम

An all-black clothing house named after Krishna.
One drop per new moon. Made in India, sold worldwide.

BRAND & BUSINESS PLAN

SEPTEMBER 2026

ALL FIGURES USD

CONFIDENTIAL

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This document combines the brand book and the business plan. The first half specifies the identity and how it is applied; the second half is the commercial case. Figures are indicative planning numbers, not audited accounts.

Western streetwear made black mean danger. We are building it on the tradition where black means god.

Krishna is painted dark because the infinite has no colour. *Shyam* is his name and it is also the Sanskrit word for black. Every garment we make is black — not as edge, not as minimalism, but as devotion. Nobody has built that brand, and the houses that could afford to cannot credibly do it.

THE NAME DOES THE WORK

Shyam is a real Indian first name. Instantly legible to those who know it, completely opaque to everyone else — the exact split Supreme had in 1994.

ONE COLOUR IS A MOAT

Competitors dilute across a seasonal palette. We compound. In five years, black done properly is a manufacturing capability nobody copies in a season.

DEVOTION OUTLASTS HYPE

Hype churns. *Bhakti* doesn't. The language comes from worship, not the street: the drop is a night, the customer is a follower.



One disc, cut once at twelve.

It is *amavasya* — the moonless night the drops fall on. It is midnight, the hour he was born, in the dark half of the month. It is a hand on a dial standing at twelve, which is why the whole calendar system falls out of it.

DISC	True circle. Never an ellipse, never a stroke.
SLOT WIDTH	5% of the diameter. At Ø20 mm that is 1 mm.
SLOT DEPTH	Exactly to the centre point. Not one per cent over.
TERMINALS	Flat and square, breaking the outer edge cleanly.
CLEAR SPACE	One quarter of the diameter on all four sides.
MINIMUM	8 mm printed, 12 mm embroidered, 16 px on screen.
UNDER 20 PX	Slot opens to 6.5% — the only exception in the system.



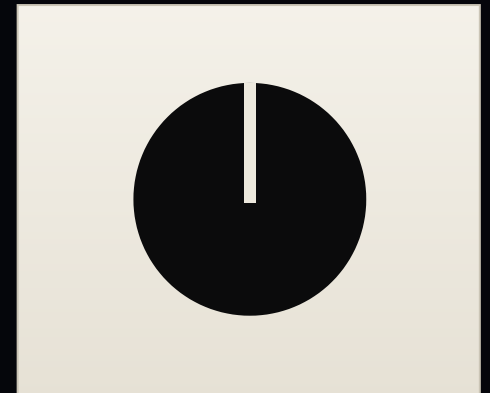
PRIMARY · STACKED



HORIZONTAL



MARK ALONE



REVERSED

ALWAYS

Cream on black is the default and covers nine tenths of everything. Gold is reserved for cast hardware and the annual Janmashtami piece. The mark may appear with no wordmark at all.

NEVER

- Never outline it, stroke it, or leave it unfilled.
- Never rotate the slot except on the drop calendar.
- Never place the mark inside another frame or badge.
- Never set the wordmark in gold.
- Never add a shadow, gradient or bevel. It is one flat colour.

The logo is the calendar.

The slot is a hand on a dial. Rotate it thirty degrees per drop and twelve positions cover a year — one for each *amavasya*. Drop 001 stands at twelve.

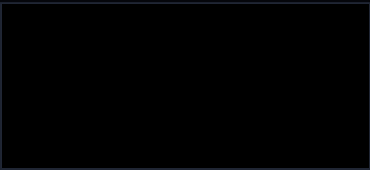
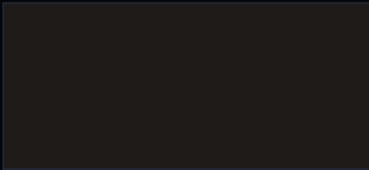
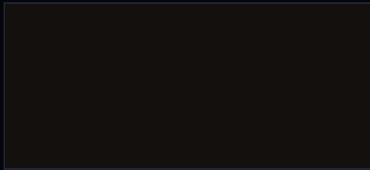
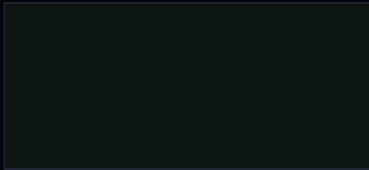
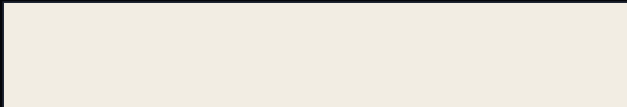
On the site it is the countdown. On a garment it says which drop the piece came from without printing a number. In a grid, the same twelve discs are the canvas repeat. One drawing, four jobs.

Drop dates are astronomical, not commercial. Nobody decides when a new moon falls, and it happens at the same instant in every market on earth.



We sell one colour, so we made five of it.

Each black is a named, repeatable dye-and-wash recipe. This is the part of the brand that becomes a manufacturing moat — and it is what the hangtag talks about instead of talking about us.

 KAJAL Kohl. Reactive-dyed, double dip. The reference black. #000000	 NEEL Blue-black. Indigo over black — the colour he is painted. #0A0F1E	 RAAKH Ash. Enzyme-washed, sun-faded on purpose. #1C1B19	 MITTI Earth. Iron-mordant natural dye, Bagru. Varies by batch. #14100E	 MOR Peacock-black. Teal cast in raking light only. #0D1512
 PITAMBAR GOLD His yellow silk. Hardware, band and thread only — never type. #C7A252	 CHANDAN The one light. Labels, print, reversed marks. #F2EDE3	THE FADE WARRANTY Black greys after twelve washes and everyone knows it. Every garment ships with a numbered card: if Kajal fades within two years we re-dye it free, forever, anywhere in the world. Modelled at a 4% claim rate and \$18 a claim.		

SHYAM श्याम

Instrument Serif · Tiro Devanagari Sanskrit

WORDMARK · HEADLINES · THE DEVANAGARI

Drop 001 · 1,310 units

Archivo · Instrument Sans

LABELS · DATA · RUNNING TEXT · THE SITE

THE RULE THAT MATTERS

Devanagari is **never letterspaced**. Tracking breaks the conjuncts and the word stops being a word. Latin is tracked +180; Devanagari is set as drawn.

EQUAL, NOT SUBTITLED

श्याम is part of the identity, not a translation of it. It appears at a size that reads as a signature, never as a caption.

NUMERALS

Drops, unit counts and prices are always tabular. A drop is **001**, never **1**. Editions are always out of 108.

Say less than you could.

The brand withholds. Copy is short, flat and specific — a dye recipe, a weight in gsm, a date. No adjectives doing work a fact could do. We never explain the reference; the people it is for already know.

HOW IT SOUNDS

Yes: “260 gsm compact cotton. Kajal, double-dipped. 300 made.”

Yes: “The room stays dark until the moon does.”

No: “Inspired by the timeless spirit of Lord Krishna, this luxurious piece...”

The line we sell against: *You've been wearing black your whole life. You just didn't know whose it was.*



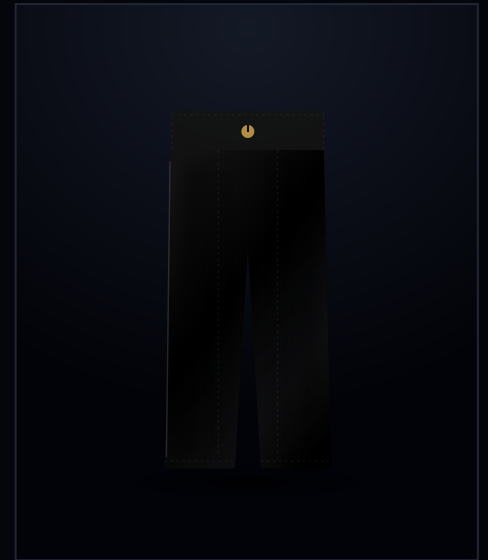
BANSURI HOODIE · \$165



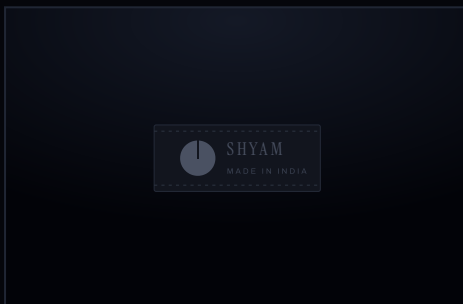
KURTA SHIRT · \$125



BOXY TEE · \$60



DRAPE TROUSER · \$145



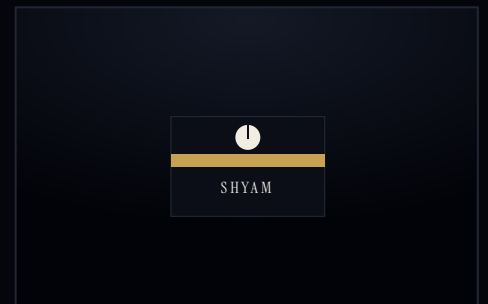
WOVEN LABEL · TONAL



BRASS BUTTON · CAST GROOVE



HANGTAG · BLIND DEBOSS



BOX · PITAMBAR BAND



PART TWO

The business.

Made in India, sold worldwide from day one. Direct only — no wholesale, no marketplaces, no paid media. All figures USD.

REVENUE, YEAR 1

\$1.33 M

Twelve drops, 87% blended sell-through, direct only.

GROSS MARGIN

76%

After dye, cut-make-trim, packaging and a 6% reject allowance.

EBITDA, YEAR 1

\$716 K

No paid media, no wholesale discount, no retail rent.

CAPITAL REQUIRED

\$45 K

To Drop 001. Self-funding from Drop 002 onward.

WHAT THE BUSINESS IS

An all-black premium apparel house named after Krishna. Indian silhouettes cut with streetwear construction, priced **\$38–\$1,100**, released only on the night of the new moon and never restocked.

Eight to ten pieces per drop, 1,300–1,600 units, sold direct from our own storefront. Duties paid at checkout, shipped worldwide. Nothing to wholesale, marketplaces or resellers.

WHY IT WORKS

Scarcity nobody has to justify. The calendar is astronomical, and it opens at the same second in every market.

A category nobody occupies. The \$60–\$300 band with a real Indian reference is empty worldwide.

A moat that compounds. One colour done properly becomes a manufacturing capability, not a season's palette.

The gap is structural, and it is global.

SEGMENT	WHO OCCUPIES IT	TYPICAL PIECE	WHY THEY CAN'T MOVE
Indian couture	Sabyasachi, Rahul Mishra, Anita Dongre	\$700–6,000	Occasion-led. Cannot make a \$60 tee without damaging the house.
Indian contemporary	Bhaane, NorBlackNorWhite, Kartik Research	\$25–145	Broad palettes, seasonal logic, little international distribution.
Global streetwear	Fear of God, Represent, Aimé Leon Dore	\$100–480	No cultural reference for this buyer; the drop calendar is arbitrary.
Global luxury	Dior, Gucci, Vuitton	\$1,800+	Can buy an Indian house; cannot credibly <i>be</i> one.
Shyam	Empty	\$38–1,100	—

LAUNCH MARKETS

US, UK, EU, UAE, Canada, Australia and India from Drop 001. One storefront, one currency, duties paid.

THE DIASPORA FIRST

32 million people of Indian origin outside India, concentrated in exactly our launch markets. The beachhead, not the whole market.

THEN EVERYONE ELSE

The reference does not need to be understood to work. Expect **40%** non-diaspora by Year 2.

PROOF FROM ADJACENT

ALD, Jacquemus and Ganni each built a house inside a decade at \$100–400, never fighting LVMH on price.

He already owns a lot of black.

24–34. New York, London, Dubai, Toronto, Berlin, Mumbai, Bangalore. Design, tech, film, food, architecture. Spends \$100–250 on a single garment without deliberating. Owns Fear of God and Uniqlo in the same wardrobe.

He does not want to be explained to, and he does not want to explain himself. That is the whole brief.

WHAT WE KNOW ABOUT HIM

Buys on impulse inside a window. Drop mechanics work because he is decisive and hates being sold to twice.

Reads the make, not the story. Will read a gsm and a dye recipe. Will not read brand copy.

Resells. One-per-person creates a secondary market — proof of demand and free price discovery.

Recruits. Acquisition is word of mouth and the physical drop night, not advertising.

SKU	PIECE	TIER	UNITS	PRICE	COGS	GM	GROSS
S1-01	Boxy Tee	Core	300	\$60	\$14.45	75.9%	\$13,665
S1-02	Bansuri Hoodie	Core	150	\$165	\$37.70	77.2%	\$19,095
S1-03	Kurta Shirt	Core	120	\$125	\$28.85	76.9%	\$11,538
S1-04	Drape Trouser	Core	100	\$145	\$32.45	77.6%	\$11,255
S1-05	Bandhgala Jacket	Signature	40	\$295	\$81.65	72.3%	\$8,534
S1-06	Angavastram Scarf	Signature	150	\$70	\$20.95	70.1%	\$7,358
S1-07	Six-Panel Cap	Entry	200	\$45	\$10.50	76.7%	\$6,900
S1-08	Tulsi Mala	Entry	250	\$38	\$8.30	78.2%	\$7,425
Full sell-through			1,310	\$113,050	\$27,280	75.9%	\$85,770

COGS BUILD, WORKED EXAMPLE

Boxy Tee, \$14.45: fabric \$5.10 · cut-make-trim \$4.60 · garment dye \$2.20 · trims and woven labels \$1.45 · packaging \$1.10. The 6% reject allowance is carried at drop level.

LANDED, NOT EX-WORKS

Includes inbound freight and inspection. Outbound international freight and duty sit in variable opex at about **\$11 per order** blended DDP.

SIZE CURVE

S 15% · M 32% · L 33% · XL 20%. Corrected from Drop 001 actuals before Drop 003 — the largest source of dead stock in year one.

Twelve nights a year, decided by the moon.

One drop per *amavasya*, live at the astronomical instant in UTC, so it opens at the same second in every market. One unit per piece per person. No restocks, pre-orders, back-in-stock notifications or waitlists.

Unsold stock is never discounted. It is re-dyed as **Raakh** and released into the following year's archive at the same price. The brand never runs a sale, which protects both margin and the resale market.

PUBLISHED RULES, NEVER BROKEN

1. One drop per new moon.
2. One unit per piece, per person.
3. Nothing restocked, ever.
4. No discounts, at any time.
5. Drop 002 fully in hand before Drop 001 opens.

The mechanic only becomes an asset once it is unbroken. A late drop costs the entire idea.

PHASE	DROPS	UNITS/DROP	SELL-THROUGH	REVENUE/DROP	RATIONALE
Launch	001-003	1,310	92%	\$104,000	Small seeded audience; scarcity real and visible.
Build	004-008	1,450	88%	\$110,120	Size curve corrected; list growing off resale visibility.
Scale	009-012	1,600	85%	\$117,370	All seven markets live; slack in tail sizes.

	YEAR 1	YEAR 2	YEAR 3	NOTE
Drops	12	13	13	Lunar, not calendar
Units sold	15,435	27,600	44,200	Womenswear from Y2
Average selling price	\$86	\$90	\$94	Mix shifts up, no price rises
Revenue	\$1.33 M	\$2.48 M	\$4.16 M	Direct only, all years
Gross profit	\$1.00 M	\$1.86 M	\$3.12 M	75–76% throughout
Variable opex	\$113 K	\$211 K	\$353 K	Gateway, DDP freight, exchanges
Fixed opex	\$170 K	\$390 K	\$770 K	Team, studio, one store in Y3
EBITDA	\$716 K	\$1.26 M	\$1.99 M	—
EBITDA margin	54%	51%	48%	Falls as fixed cost is added
Marketing spend	\$0	\$0	\$0	Structural, not a cost saving

WHY THE MARGIN IS HIGH

No wholesale discount (~50%), no marketplace commission (~25%), no paid acquisition (~15–25%), no markdowns. Removing those four is the delta.

WHERE IT IS FRAGILE

Assumes **85%+ sell-through**. At 65%, Y1 EBITDA falls to **\$390 K**; at 50% to **\$165 K** — survives, but stops self-funding.

WORKING CAPITAL

Each drop needs about **\$30 K** in hand 60 days ahead. From Drop 004 the previous drop funds the next.

FX EXPOSURE

Revenue USD, costs INR. Every 5% rupee appreciation costs about **1.2 points** of gross margin. Forward-cover from Y2.

Black is a manufacturing problem before it is a design problem.

The whole brand rests on five repeatable dye recipes. Three dye houses are sampled in parallel and one chosen on wash-test data, not price. Every batch is logged against a reference swatch and rejected outside tolerance. Cut-make-trim sits with two units in Tiruppur and one in Noida; no single vendor exceeds 40% of a drop.

THE 60-DAY DROP CYCLE

- D-60** Fabric booked, dye lot approved against reference.
- D-45** Cut and make begins; first-off inspected.
- D-25** 30 wash cycles on a pulled sample.
- D-18** Finishing, labels, numbered cards.
- D-10** Goods in, photographed, listed dark.
- D-0** Site lights at the astronomical instant, worldwide.

FULFILMENT

3PL in Bhiwandi. India in 48 hours; international consolidated air twice weekly out of Mumbai, DDP.

RETURNS

Exchange only, size for size, 14 days internationally. No refunds — consistent with one-per-person and no restock.

FADE WARRANTY

Free re-dye for life on Kajal, worldwide. 4% claim rate, **\$18** a claim including return freight.

STACK

Shopify headless, multi-currency, queue and bot mitigation from day one.

No paid media, ever. It contradicts the product.

1 · SEED FORTY, NOT FORTY THOUSAND

One unnumbered black tee, hand-delivered, no note, to forty specific people across New York, London, Dubai and Mumbai. If it needs a caption it isn't working.

2 · OPEN AN EMPTY ROOM

The site goes live 60 days out as a black page with a countdown and nothing else. The only shareable object is the URL.

3 · TAKE THE NUMBER, NOT THE EMAIL

SMS and WhatsApp worldwide, one message per amavasya. Higher intent than email everywhere, and we own the list.

4 · ONE PHYSICAL NIGHT

Drop 001 also opens for six hours in one unmarked room in Mumbai, lit by a single lamp. Fifty units held back.

5 · LET RESALE HAPPEN

Never fight it, never comment on it, always track it. The resale multiple is the number that says whether this works.

6 · GIVE ONE AWAY A YEAR

On Janmashtami the Mor piece is not sold. 108 units, given to people who write in about the black they already own.

CAC

\$5

Y1 blended, seeding and drop night only.

REPEAT RATE

38%

Target by Drop 006. Decides Year 2.

CONTRIBUTION / CUSTOMER

\$63

First purchase, after variable cost.

RESALE MULTIPLE

1.4–2.2×

Target for Drop 001 within 90 days.

USE OF FUNDS	AMOUNT
Inventory, Drop 001 — landed COGS, 1,310 units	\$27,300
Site & photography — headless build, queue, imagery	\$5,000
Trademark, entity, legal — classes 25 & 35, then Madrid	\$3,600
Launch night & seeding — room, lighting, 40 units	\$5,000
Dye sampling & wash testing — three houses, 30 cycles	\$1,700
Contingency — ~6% on a first production run	\$2,400
Total to Drop 001 · self-funding thereafter	\$45,000

TWO WAYS IN

\$45 K friends-and-family to reach Drop 001 and prove sell-through. No institutional round is needed to reach profitability.

\$300 K seed, optional, post Drop 003 to compress Year 2: womenswear, a US-side 3PL, and pulling the Year 3 store forward.

The decision to raise should be made on Drop 003 data — resale multiple and repeat rate — not before.

RISK	SEVERITY	MITIGATION
The black greys within a year	Critical	The warranty becomes a liability and the one promise breaks in public. Three dye houses, 30 wash cycles, before any copy is written. The warranty is not published until the data supports it.
Sell-through below 65%	High	Cut Drop 001 conservatively. Correct the size curve before Drop 003. Unsold stock re-dyed as Raakh, never discounted.
A drop slips	High	Drop 002 fully in hand before 001 opens, permanently keeping one drop of buffer.
Trademark cannot be held	High	“Shyam” is a common personal name. The device protects the business — file disc plus wordmark as a composite in classes 25 and 35.
Customs and DDP friction	Medium	Duties paid at checkout. HS codes confirmed per market before Drop 001; a refused first international order is a permanent reputational cost.
Religious sensitivity	Medium	Reverent register, no figurative depiction, nothing on garments worn below the waist. Each line reviewed with a scholar.

WHEN	MILESTONE	GATE TO PASS
Now	Dye house selection, wash-test programme begins	One house holds Kajal through 30 cycles
+3 weeks	Mark and wordmark to final vector; trademark filed	Device accepted for filing in class 25
+4 weeks	HS codes and DDP rates confirmed for seven markets	Landed cost per market inside \$14
+5 weeks	Drop 001 cut and make begins	Fabric and dye lot approved against reference
+6 weeks	Site live as an empty room with the countdown	1,000 numbers on the list before drop night
11 Oct 2026	Drop 001 — worldwide, and one unmarked room	80%+ sell-through in 72 hours
10 Nov 2026	Drop 002 — already in hand before 001 opened	Ships on the instant, no slip
Dec 2026	Drop 003; decision point on the seed round	Repeat above 25%, resale above 1.0×
Sep 2027	Janmashtami piece — 108 units, given not sold	—

All figures in USD and are indicative planning numbers built from vendor estimates and comparable-brand benchmarks — not audited accounts or a commissioned market study. INR costs converted at 83 to the dollar. Costs must be locked against real quotes and the market sizing independently validated before any priced round. New-moon dates are computed from the mean synodic month and must be confirmed against a panchang before printing. The mark is production-ready as specified; the wordmark beside it is set in a licensed typeface and must be redrawn as custom outlines before filing or printing.



You've been wearing black your whole life.
You just didn't know whose it was.

SHYAM · श्याम

DROP 001 · 11 OCTOBER 2026